

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR RECRUITMENT OF LECTURER
(CONTRACT), GOVT. HIGHER SECONDARY SCHOOL, SERCHHIP UNDER
SCHOOL EDUCATION DEPARTMENT, GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(MARCH & APRIL, 2026)
GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

PART - A (Multiple Choice Questions) (66 Marks)

All questions carry equal mark of 1 each. Attempt all questions.

*This section should be answered only on the **OMR Response Sheet** provided.*

Direction (Question Nos. 1 - 30): Choose the correct parts of speech:

1. She spoke eloquently at the conference. Identify the part of speech of the underlined word:
(a) Adjective (b) Noun
(c) Adverb (d) Verb
2. Which part of speech expresses emotion?
(a) Noun (b) Verb
(c) Interjection (d) Preposition
3. “That” in the sentence, “I believe that honesty is the best policy”, functions as
(a) Demonstrative adjective (b) Relative pronoun
(c) Conjunction (d) Adverb
4. Choose the sentence where “fast” is used as an adjective.
(a) They caught the fast train. (b) He runs fast.
(c) She held fast to her beliefs. (d) Time goes fast.
5. The blue car is hers. In the sentence, “hers” is a:
(a) Possessive adjective (b) Reflexive pronoun
(c) Possessive pronoun (d) Demonstrative pronoun
6. Which sentence contains a coordinating conjunction?
(a) She stayed because she was tired. (b) He is poor but honest.
(c) Although he tried, he failed. (d) If you work hard, you will succeed.
7. The word “he” is a:
(a) Noun (b) Pronoun
(c) Adjective (d) Verb
8. Choose the sentence where “light” is used as a noun.
(a) This bag is light. (b) Please light the candle.
(c) The light is too bright. (d) She wore a light dress.

9. Identify the part of speech of the underlined word: Alas! He is no more.
(a) Interjection (b) Adverb
(c) Conjunction (d) Preposition
10. Either you apologize or you leave. In the sentence, “either” functions as a/an:
(a) Adjective (b) Conjunction
(c) Adverb (d) Pronoun
11. Which word is a verb?
(a) Carry (b) Reservation
(c) Active (d) Tasty
12. Which part of speech describes a noun?
(a) Verb (b) Adjective
(c) Pronoun (d) Conjunction
13. Which word replaces a noun?
(a) Adjective (b) Verb
(c) Pronoun (d) Adverb
14. Which is a common noun?
(a) India (b) Lotus
(c) Teacher (d) Christmas
15. A verb that requires a direct object to complete its meaning is called a:
(a) Linking verb (b) Auxiliary verb
(c) Intransitive verb (d) Transitive verb
16. Which word describes a verb?
(a) Beautiful (b) Quickly
(c) Sad (d) Precious
17. Which word is an uncountable noun?
(a) Pepper (b) Lipstick
(c) Helmet (d) Knife
18. A non-finite verb ending in –ing that functions as a noun is called a:
(a) Participle (b) Gerund
(c) Infinitive (d) Auxiliary
19. Which word is a reflexive pronoun?
(a) He (b) Himself
(c) Him (d) His
20. Identify the transitive verb
(a) He laughed loudly. (b) She bought a car.
(c) They arrived late. (d) The baby slept.
21. In “The glass broke,” the verb is:
(a) Transitive (b) Intransitive
(c) Both (d) None
22. In “Think before you act,” the word “before” is,
(a) Preposition (b) Adverb
(c) Subordinating conjunction (d) Coordinating conjunction

23. A word that modifies a verb, an adjective, or another adverb is called:
(a) Adjective (b) Preposition
(c) Adverb (d) Conjunction
24. The music is very loud. In this sentence, "music" is a:
(a) Adjective (b) Noun
(c) Adverb (d) Conjunction
25. Which word is a linking verb?
(a) Run (b) Jump
(c) Is (d) Write
26. Sanga grabs the snake _____ its tail.
(a) by (b) beside
(c) in (d) through
27. This house is very big. "This" is:
(a) Adjective (b) Adverb
(c) Verb (d) Pronoun
28. The criminal was condemned by everyone. "everyone" is:
(a) Adjective (b) Pronoun
(c) Noun (d) Verb
29. She bought a sharp knife. "sharp" is:
(a) Adjective (b) Adverb
(c) Noun (d) Pronoun
30. The lion pounced _____ the hunter.
(a) to (b) above
(c) upon (d) unto

Direction (Question Nos. 31- 46): Fill in the blanks with the most appropriate option given:

31. She was praised for her _____ behaviour during the crisis.
(a) cowardly (b) calm
(c) rude (d) selfish
32. The company plans to _____ its services next year given its good reputation this year.
(a) expand (b) shrink
(c) ignore (d) counsel
33. His explanation was so _____ that everyone understood it easily.
(a) confusing (b) thorough
(c) vague (d) complex
34. She has _____ friends than her sister.
(a) lesser (b) fewer
(c) few (d) smallest
35. Soft minded individuals are _____ to fall for all kind of superstitions.
(a) reluctant (b) resilient
(c) prone (d) embrace
36. His arguments were so _____ that no one could refute them.
(a) tenuous (b) cogent
(c) trivial (d) redundant

37. He asked me where _____ going.
(a) was I (b) I was
(c) am I (d) I am
38. Neither of the books _____.
(a) is interesting (b) were interesting
(c) have been interesting (d) are interesting
39. Each of the players _____.
(a) have submitted his report (b) has submitted their reports
(c) has submitted his report (d) have submitted their report
40. Choose the word closest in meaning to "Obdurate".
(a) flexible (b) stubborn
(c) hesitant (d) innocent
41. Choose the word opposite in meaning to "Ephemeral".
(a) transient (b) fleeting
(c) eternal (d) fragile
42. A _____ of ships were seen entering the border.
(a) swarm (b) group
(c) fleet (d) basket
43. I saw a _____ of cows in the field.
(a) group (b) herd
(c) swarm (d) flock
44. One who compiles a dictionary is called:
(a) Biographer (b) Editor
(c) Lexicographer (d) Translator
45. One who knows everything is called:
(a) omniscient (b) atheist
(c) novice (d) amateur
46. One who studies stars and planets is called:
(a) Astrologer (b) Astronomer
(c) Geologist (d) Biologist

Direction (Question Nos. 47 - 51) Fill in the blanks with the appropriate form of the verbs from the given choices:

47. Listen! The baby _____.
(a) cries (b) cried
(c) is crying (d) has cried
48. We _____ dinner when the phone rang.
(a) have (b) were having
(c) are having (d) had
49. I _____ my homework already.
(a) finish (b) finished
(c) have finished (d) finishing

50. Look at those clouds! It _____ rain.

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| (a) will | (b) is going to |
| (c) was going to | (d) has |

51. By next year, she _____ her degree.

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| (a) completes | (b) completed |
| (c) will complete | (d) will have completed |

Direction (Question Nos. 52 - 54): Choose the correct word to connect the following sentences:

52. He was tired, _____ he continued working.

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| (a) but | (b) because |
| (c) although | (d) if |

53. You cannot succeed _____ you work hard.

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| (a) unless | (b) if |
| (c) when | (d) because |

54. I will call you _____ I reach home.

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| (a) when | (b) since |
| (c) nevertheless | (d) thereafter |

Direction (Question Nos. 55 - 57): Choose the correct transformation for the following sentences as directed.

55. It is a very difficult task. (Identify the exclamatory form of the sentence)

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| (a) What a difficult task it is! | (b) How difficult is the task! |
| (c) What difficult the task is! | (d) How it is a difficult task! |

56. He is always punctual. (Choose the correct negative form of the sentence)

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| (a) He is never late. | (b) He is not punctual always. |
| (c) He is not always punctual. | (d) He is rarely punctual. |

57. They will attend the wedding. (Choose the correct negative interrogative form of the sentence.)

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| (a) Will they not attend the wedding? | (b) Won't they not attend the wedding? |
| (c) Will not they attend the wedding? | (d) Will they attend the wedding? |

Direction (Question Nos. 58 - 61): Identify the underlined part of each sentence by choosing the correct options given below each sentence:

58. He ran fast because he was late.

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| (a) Noun clause | (b) Adjective clause |
| (c) Adverb clause | (d) Prepositional phrase |

59. The girl who won the prize is my sister.

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| (a) Noun clause | (b) Adverb clause |
| (c) Adjective clause | (d) Infinitive phrase |

60. She believes what you said.

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| (a) Relative clause | (b) Noun clause |
| (c) Adverb clause | (d) Adjective phrase |

61. I was surprised at his behaviour.

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| (a) Adjective clause | (b) Prepositional phrase |
| (c) Noun clause | (d) Gerund clause |

Ditection (Question Nos. 62 - 66): Change the sentence into indirect speech:

62. He said, "I will finish the work tomorrow."
(a) He said that he will finish the work the next day.
(b) He said that he would finish the work the next day.
(c) He said that he would finish the work tomorrow.
(d) He said that he will finish the work tomorrow.
63. She said, "Where are you going?"
(a) She asked where I was going. (b) She asked where was I going.
(c) She asked where I am going. (d) She asked where am I going.
64. The teacher said, "Students must complete their assignments today."
(a) The teacher said that students must complete their assignments that day.
(b) The teacher said that students might complete their assignments that day.
(c) The teacher said students must completed their assignments that day.
(d) The teacher said that students have to complete their assignments that day.
65. He said to me, "Open the door."
(a) He told me open the door. (b) He told me to open the door.
(c) He said me to open the door. (d) He told me opening the door.
66. She said, "I cannot solve this problem."
(a) She said that she cannot solve that problem.
(b) She said that she could not solve that problem.
(c) She said that she could not solve the problem.
(d) She said that she cannot solve this problem.

PART- B (Conventional Type) (34 Marks)

*This section should be answered only on the **Answer Sheet** provided.
Marks for each question is indicated against its.*

1. Write a precis of the following passage and provide a suitable title: (14)

Approximately 80 percent of young people who possess smartphones are capable of locating a particular video on YouTube, and of this group, 90 percent know how to share it with a friend. In addition, 70 percent can navigate the internet to seek answers to inquiries, while close to two-thirds are able to set an alarm for specific times. A little more than one-third can use Google Maps to ascertain the duration of travel between two destinations. During these digital assessments, boys tended to perform better than girls in most tasks. However, the primary factor in this case appeared to be smartphone ownership. Among those who knew how to use smartphones, 43.7 percent boys and 19.8 percent girls actually owned the smartphone. When the differences in ownership disappear, so does the difference in digital skills between boys and girls. Computer ownership was found to be far lower than smartphones (less than 10 percent), but there were similar trends in digital skill patterns. Digital literacy is directly proportional to increased access to devices. The survey clearly indicated that young people look at technology as a pathway for creative expression. Approximately 78 percent use their smartphones for entertainment-related activities such as watching movies or listening to music, 57 percent play games regularly, and 90 percent had used some form of social media in the previous week.

2. You have come across an advertisement in a newspaper for the post of a **lecturer in Lianbuanga Memorial Higher Secondary School**. As candidate XXX living at MINECO, write a letter to the **Principal** applying for the job. Provide a suitable resume without revealing your identity. (10)
3. Read the passage below carefully and answer the questions that follow:

India is an ancient land with a long and complex history. Throughout the centuries many races and cultures have come to this land, settled here, and contributed something to its life. Some came as conquerors, some as traders, and others as travelers in search of knowledge. Yet in spite of these many influences, India has preserved a certain unity which has held its people together. This unity does not come from uniformity. On the contrary, India is a land of remarkable diversity. There are many languages spoken in different regions, numerous religious beliefs practiced by its people, and a wide variety of customs and traditions that shape everyday life.

Yet beneath this diversity there lies a deeper cultural bond. Over long periods of time, ideas, philosophies, and ways of life have interacted with one another and gradually formed a shared civilization. Pilgrimages, trade routes, literature, and philosophical discussions helped create connections between distant regions. In this way, people living in different parts of the country came to feel that they belonged to a larger cultural whole.

India has often been described as a meeting place of cultures. Foreign influences were not always rejected; many were absorbed and transformed into something new. This ability to absorb and adapt has been one of the distinctive features of Indian civilization. Rather than destroying earlier traditions, new ideas were often woven into the existing fabric of society.

Thus the history of India is not merely a record of kings and battles. It is also the story of how different peoples and traditions gradually learned to live together and create a shared cultural heritage. This process has given India its unique character and enduring strength.

Answer the following questions;

- (a) How did different cultures contribute to Indian civilization? (2)
- (b) Where does the unity in India come from? (2)
- (c) What gradually formed a shared civilization? (2)
- (d) Why is India described as a “meeting place of cultures”? (2)
- (e) What has given India its unique character and enduring strength? (2)

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